under privileged rural industries, low income, indebtedness and existence of inequality in land holdings and assets. In fertile areas, a few absentee landlords own large area and they do not evince greater Interest in improving the performance of agriculture.

5. **Social and Cultural Problems:** Caste system makes villages almost rigid. Dominant Caste in village holds all land holdings so they will be the superior class too. Both class and caste exploitation will be at their peaks. Poverty, mal – nourishment, illiteracy, child marriages and many more can be seen in Indian villages. Inter caste/ Religion marriage will leads to assassination in rural areas. Child marriage leads to lots of unethical issues. Female feticide leads to gender related issues in rural areas.

6. **Leadership Related Problems:** The specific leadership related problems found in rural areas are: Leadership among the hands of inactive and incompetent people, self-interest of leaders, biased political will, less bargaining power and negation skills and dominance of political leaders.

7. **Administrative Problems:** The rural administrative problems consist of political interference, lack of motivation and interest, low wages in villages, improper utilization of budget, and absence of monitoring and implementation of rural development programme.

Rural poverty, rural unemployment, rural industries, micro finance, rural heath and sanitation and rural infrastructures are the issues that are considered for detailed discussion.

10.6 Rural Poverty

Rural poverty refers to the existence of poverty in rural areas. Poverty in India has been defined as the situation in which an individual fails to earn sufficient income to buy the basic minimum of subsistence. Poverty line is a hypothetical line based on income or consumption levels that divides the population as people below poverty line and above poverty line. On the basis of recommended nutritional intake, persons consuming less than 2,400 calories per day in rural areas are treated as they are under rural poverty.

As per the Planning Commission estimates, the percentage of people living below poverty in rural areas was 54.10 which accounted for 33.80 per cent during 2009-10. Poverty is deepest among members of scheduled castes and tribes in the rural areas. In 2005 these groups accounted for 80 per cent of rural poor, although their share in the total rural population is much smaller. In 2015, more than 80 crores of India's people lived in villages. One quarter of village population (22 crores people) list below the poverty line. India is the home to 22 per cent of the world's poor. It is needless to state that the country has been successful in reducing the proportion of poor people, in spite of increasing of population.

10.6.1 Causes for Rural Poverty

Various factors responsible for rural poverty are highlighted below:

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